

MEET THE ALL-STARS

Brookside



Robbie Jackman

HEIGHT/POSITION: 6-3, post
PARENTS: Mr. and Mrs. Jackman
LETTERS WON: 2
1997-98 STATS: 334 points; 16.7 ppg, 4.9 rebounds per game; 45% field goal shooting; 66% free-throw shooting; 82 assists
BASKETBALL HONORS: First team All-Lorain County Division II
FUTURE PLANS: Undecided

THE 19TH ANNUAL Lorain County Senior Boys All-Star Basketball Games will be played March 31 at Elyria Catholic High School. Sponsored by The Lorain County Boys Basketball Coaches Association and The Chronicle-Telegram, the evening will feature two games. The game between Division I-II players will begin at 6 p.m., with Divisions III-IV meeting in the nightcap. Coca-Cola's presentation of the 1998 Lorain County Mr. Basketball Award, plus induction ceremonies for the Lorain County Basketball Coaches Association Hall of Fame will be between games.

Amherst Steele



Amanda Byar

HEIGHT/POSITION: 5-5, guard
LETTERS WON: 2 basketball
1997-98 STATS: 143 points; 6.8 ppg; 1.1 rebounds per game; 46.0% field-goal shooting; 72.2% free-throw shooting; 74 assists
FUTURE PLANS: Ohio University or Miami University to study athletic training.



Erin Johnson

HEIGHT/POSITION: 5-5, guard
LETTERS WON: 3 basketball
1997-98 STATS: 92 points; 4.4 ppg; 2.4 rebounds per game; 39.0% field-goal shooting; 75.7% free-throw shooting; 3.6 assists per game.
FUTURE PLANS: Cleveland State to play tennis and major in speech.

THE 18TH ANNUAL Lorain County Senior Girls All-Star Basketball Games will be played March 25 at Midview High School. Sponsored by The Lorain County Girls Basketball Coaches Association and The Chronicle-Telegram, the evening will feature two games. The game featuring Division III-IV players will begin at 6:30 p.m., with Divisions I-II meeting in the nightcap. Coca-Cola's presentation of the 1998 Lorain County Miss Basketball Award will conclude the evening. WEOL AM-930 will air the games and the awards ceremony.

Falls gives champs a fright

Benedictine finally shakes 'Dogs in fourth

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — Olmsted Falls' gutsy, swarming little guys nearly pulled one out against the defending state champs Wednesday night.

In a fight for survival in a Division II district semifinal, the Bulldogs scared the daylights out of Benedictine before the poised and bigger Bengals came from behind in the fourth quarter for a 77-68 win.

The defeat ended the Bulldogs' string of three straight district championships and their season at 17-5.

Behind the clutch 3-point shooting of senior Keith Knapp, smaller Falls held the lead with five minutes left in the game.

And they were knocking at the door again with a minute to go.

But tourney-smart Benedictine scored the last six points to knock Falls out of the tournament for the second year in a row.

The Bengals came from behind in the fourth quarter last March to top the Bulldogs, 64-57, in the regional championship game at the University of Toledo. A week later, they won the state Division II title in Columbus.

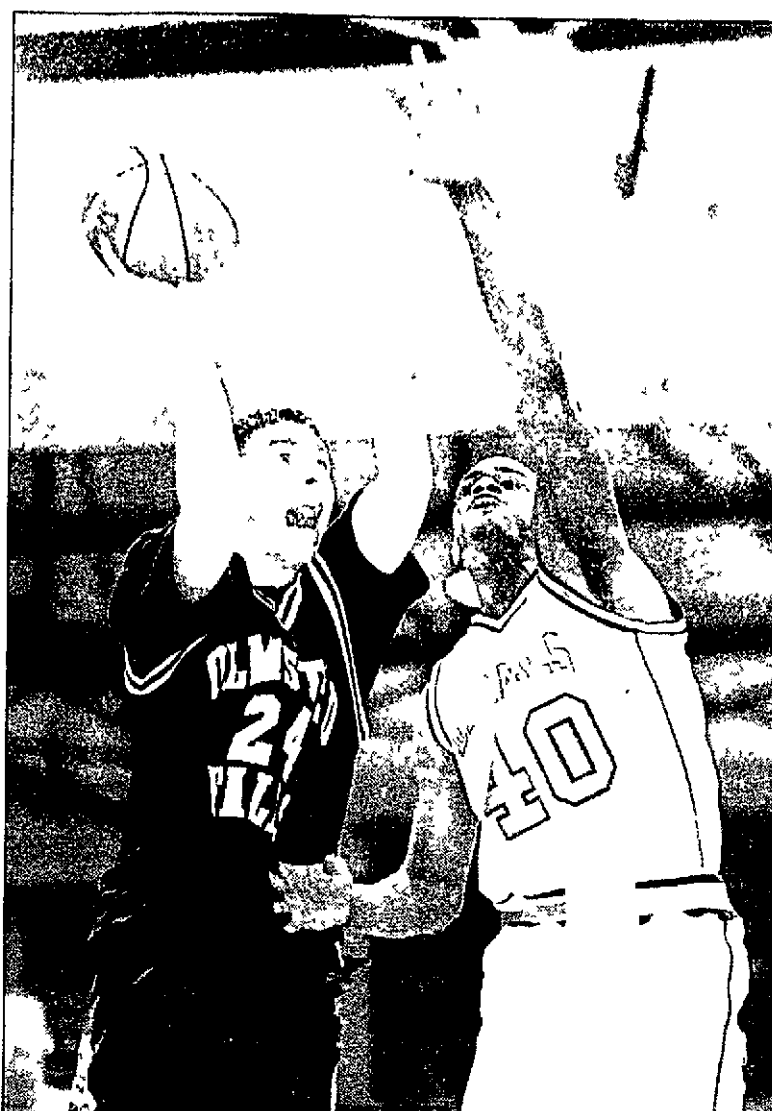
Benedictine (15-8) plays the winner of tonight's semifinal match between Rocky River and Fairview for the district title at 7 p.m. Saturday. The district champ advances to the Bowling Green regional next week.

"They (Falls) came to play," said Benedictine coach Frank Novak. "They shot well, they got after it and they gave us a lot of problems."

After trailing by six at the break, Olmsted Falls fell behind by 13 points, 46-33, three minutes into the third quarter.

But that's when the 'Dogs went to work.

Junior Sean Radigan hit a shot from the left side of the lane. Freshman Mike Gansey drove the lane for a layup, was fouled on the play and converted the



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

A SHOT AND A SHOUT: Olmsted Falls' Mike Gansey is determined as he goes to the basket against Benedictine's Jermaine Crosby

free throw. Senior Rob Szczec scored on a goaltending call, and Benedictine asked for timeout with 3:11 left in the period, its lead cut to six.

The Bengals pushed the lead back to nine, but Falls ran off the last eight points of the quarter and it was 50-49, Benedictine, heading into the fourth.

Knapp, who drained three 3-pointers the first half, drilled his fourth of the night after a basket by Gansey in the paint, and at 5:47 of the period Olmsted Falls took a lead, 56-55, for the first time since the second quarter.

Brian Williams' two foul shots at 5:25 made it 58-55 Falls, but the Bengals began to stir. They took a 59-58 lead at 4:18, then Michael

Woods, a 6-foot-1 junior, scored two straight baskets off steals within 18 seconds and they never trailed again.

Falls sophomore Larry Mucha and Knapp buried 3-pointers and Radigan scored a layup off a steal to pull the Bulldogs within three, 71-68, with just over a minute to go.

But that was as far as they got.

"I told the kids all week I thought we could win this game," said Bulldog coach Pat Donahue, "and up to the last 30 seconds of the game, I still thought we had a shot."

"I can't tell you how proud I am of this team. I'm prouder of them than any other team I ever coached, because everybody

DIVISION I

St. Edward makes final

GRAFTON — Lakewood St. Edward placed three players in double figures and went out to a 37-23 lead at the half in downing Lakewood, 66-45, Wednesday night in a Division I District semifinal at Midview High School.

Steve Logan led the Eagles and all scorers, with 22 points, while Sam Clancy scored 12 and Steve LePore contributed 10.

The Eagles will face the winner of tonight's Medina-Lorain Admiral King game for the district championship Saturday night.

Tim Budzar led the Rangers, who end their season at 13-9, with 13 points

Lakewood	G	F	T	StEd	G	F	T
YBudzar	6	0	13	Logan	10	1	22
Olson	4	0	8	Clancy	4	4	12
Paffon	2	2	7	LePore	3	2	10
Rustad	2	1	7	Lukovic	3	0	7
DBudzar	2	1	5	Newman	2	2	6
Fischer	1	1	3	Barie	2	0	5
Bechtel	1	0	2	Myles	2	0	4
Totals	18	4	45	Totals	26	9	68
	Points by Quarters				Points by Quarters		
Lakewood				St. Eds.			
	8	15	9		13	18	11
	45				66		
Three-point goals Lakewood — Rustad 2, Paffon 1, Fischer 1, Budzar 1				St. Edward — LePore 2, Lukovic 1, Logan, Barie			

expected us to play .500 basketball."

Knapp's 22 points with five threes led all scorers. Gansey scored 12 and Radigan 10. Woods led Benedictine with 19. Junior Curtis Matthews added 15 and senior Albert Wilson 12.

OFalls	G	F	T	Benedictine	G	F	T
Mucha	2	2	7	Paul	0	0	0
Knapp	2	3	22	Slory	3	3	9
Koch	0	0	0	Woods	6	6	19
MWilliams	3	0	6	Leanza	3	2	9
Szczec	2	0	4	Matthews	6	3	15
Gansey	2	2	12	Novak	2	0	4
BWilliams	1	4	6	Kaser	0	0	0
Radigan	4	2	10	Crosby	3	1	7
Church	0	0	0	Hagler	1	0	2
Holland	0	1	1	Wilson	6	0	12
Miller	0	0	0				
Jarscak	0	0	0				
Totals	24	14	68	Totals	30	15	77
	Points by Quarters				Points by Quarters		
OFalls				Benedictine			
	17	10	22		19	18	17
	68				77		
Three-point goals Olmsted Falls — Knapp 5, Mucha, Benedictine — Woods, Leanza							

Shelby blows down Sailors

Joe Barry
The Chronicle-Telegram

ASHLAND — Outshot, out-rebounded and outrun.

Such were the shortfalls that ended Vermilion's season as Shelby led wire to wire, sinking the Sailors 69-51 in Division II semi-final boys basketball game Wednesday night.

The loss ended Vermilion's six-game winning streak as well as any hope it had of advancing to the regionals in Bowling Green.

Kurt Keplinger's game-high 20 points, combined with 15 from Josh Steele, 13 from Toby Steps and 10 from Joel Hinkel, were more than enough to pace Shelby. David Cyrek's 16 points led the Sailors while teammate Zach Pretzer added 11.

The Whippets scored early and often, jumping out to a 12-4 lead midway through the opening quarter. Led by 11 points from Keplinger, a senior, and five from Steele, Shelby dropped in 20 in the first, and held a six-point lead.

Cyrek's eight first-quarter points enabled Vermilion to stay within striking distance, but after Shelby opened the second

Vermilion	G	F	T	Shelby	G	F	T
Colatruglio	0	0	0	Heiland	0	0	0
Smith	0	0	0	Steele	5	3	13
Jones	0	0	0	Hammann	2	4	9
Pretzer	0	5	0	Keplinger	9	0	20
Fackler	0	0	0	Hummel	0	0	0
Cyrek	8	0	16	Richards	0	0	0
Keller	1	5	7	Will	0	0	0
Dahlke	3	1	7	Stacklin	0	0	0
Cooper	0	0	0	Hankel	4	2	10
Dominick	0	0	0	Wolford	1	0	2
Vndruska N	2	0	4	Steele	6	3	15
Vndruska B	3	0	6				
Totals	22	5	67	Totals	27	12	69
	Points by Quarters				Points by Quarters		
Vermilion				Shelby			
	14	13	11		13	11	13
	51				69		
Three-point goals Vermilion Pretzer 2, Hammann, Keplinger 2							

period with a 9-4 run that extended its lead to double digits, it was obvious the Sailors' ship was definitely taking on water.

Just before the half, however, a late 3 from Pretzer cut the Shelby lead to seven and kept the contest somewhat in doubt. Rebounds were the key to the first half, with the Whippets better than doubling the Sailors in boards at 20-9.

"They played good defense, and we played none," disappointed Sailor coach Bob Walsh said. "We didn't give near the performance that you need to give at this level to win."

The second half was much the

same as the first, with Shelby shooting a sizzling 68 percent from the field, while Vermilion struggled to find the basket, posting a dismal 30-percent effort in the final two quarters.

Whippet shooter after shooter penetrated the thin Sailor defenses in a third quarter that featured Steps' acrobatic lay-ins. An exclamation-point slam by Josh Steele late in the period all but sealed Vermilion's fate, as the Sailors found themselves down by 14 and sinking fast at period's end.

"We wanted to push the tempo as much as we could tonight," Shelby coach Francis Scruci said. "We played to our gameplan, you couldn't have scripted it any better."

Frustrated by the Whippets' rebounding prowess and relentless scoring, the Sailors were only able to get within 12 points of the lead before succumbing by 18.

The loss ended Vermilion's season at 14-9, while Shelby upped its mark to 18-4, and will advance to face Bellevue in the final Saturday. Bellevue nipped Galion 37-36 earlier.

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